

The in-flight safety announcement that included the humor of the flight attendant demonstrates the shift from compliance to commitment, brought about by Soft HRM practices." Employees are no longer regarded as "costs to be controlled" (Hard HRM). Instead, they are treated as "assets to be developed." This leads to intrinsic motivation and self-regulation, where the workers are motivated and moved by inner psychological rewards, such as the enjoyment of satisfied customers, instead of the avoidance of punishment for non-compliance."

This requires organizations to be involved in Strategic HRM, people plans integrated with organizational strategy. This focuses on culture, not control, to establish high commitment with trust rather than strict standardization.

In these companies, by hiring based on attitude (or relationship skills) and by giving leaders permission to empower and not micromanage, there can be a spread of authenticity. The key to their success lies in the ability to use and capitalize on the exclusivity of human skills to turn ordinary interactions into unforgettable experiences through the power of autonomy.